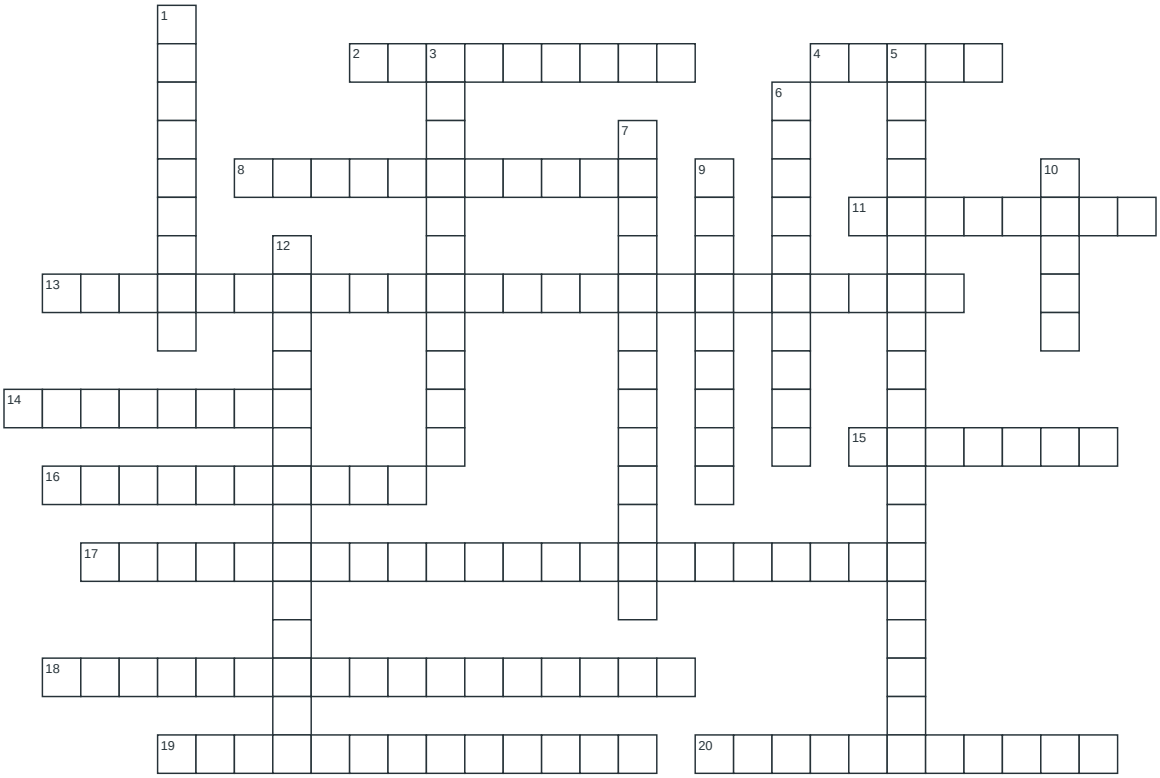
Earth's History Crossword

Hard | 20 clues | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Use the clues to complete the grid. Omit spaces, punctuation, and hyphens.



ACROSS

2. Growth of a body as smaller particles collide and combine

4. Definition of the physical state of Earth's inner core

8. Geologic era associated with the dominance of non-avian dinosaurs

11. Geologic era includes most of the time non-avian dinosaurs lived

13. Separation of planetary material into layers with different properties

14. Presence of people or assets where a hazard could occur.

15. Ancient supercontinent that included nearly all of Earth’s land.

16. One plate descending beneath another

17. Way in which fast do most tectonic plates move

18. Two oceanic plates converge, and one subducts. Which feature is likely nearby

ACROSS (continued)

19. Photosynthetic bacteria that contributed to oxygen in Earth’s early atmosphere

20. Rigid outer layer of Earth made of the crust and uppermost mantle.

DOWN

1. At which boundary do plates move apart

3. Geologic era following the Mesozoic and continuing to the present

5. Commonly forms when two continental plates collide

6. Continental crust begins stretching and breaking along a divergent boundary. Which feature may develop

7. At a transform boundary, plates mainly move in which way

9. Approximate age of Earth based on radiometric dating

10. A rock can consist of one or more minerals

12. Geologically rapid loss of many species across the world

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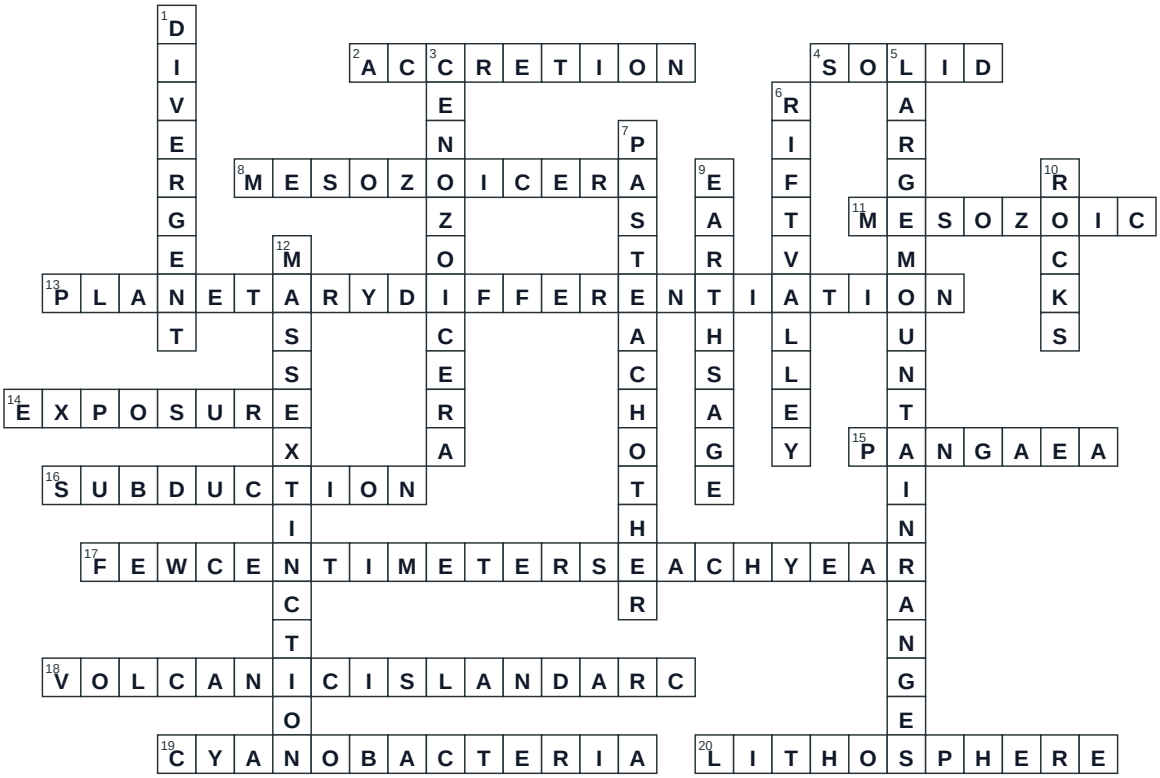
Hard | 20 clues | Teacher Answer Key

TEACHER ANSWER KEY

Completed grid and numbered answers. Spaces and punctuation are omitted in the grid.



ACROSS

2. Accretion
4. Solid
8. Mesozoic Era
11. Mesozoic
13. Planetary Differentiation
14. Exposure
15. Pangaea
16. Subduction
17. Few Centimeters Each Year
18. Volcanic Island Arc
19. Cyanobacteria

ACROSS (continued)

20. Lithosphere

DOWN

1. Divergent
3. Cenozoic Era
5. Large Mountain Ranges
6. Rift Valley
7. Past Each Other
9. Earth's Age
10. Rocks
12. Mass Extinction

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